Craftsmen App

Project objective

The project aims to develop a reliable digital application that brings together craftsmen on a single platform. This platform will provide users with quick access to information about the services offered, including service type, price, and reviews, while fostering a comprehensive environment for quality service and trust between both parties. The application will act as a reliable link between craft service providers and clients, with the goal of regulating the home services sector, increasing job opportunities for craftsmen, and saving time and effort for those seeking reliable services.

Main objectives of the project

1. **Facilitating access to services**
   Providing a fast and efficient way to find qualified craftsmen without random searching or relying on unreliable recommendations.
2. **Enhancing transparency**
   Clearly displaying prices, portfolio photos, and customer reviews to empower users to make informed decisions.
3. **Supporting tradespeople**
   Giving tradespeople a professional platform to showcase their skills, expand their client base, and build a digital reputation based on reviews.
4. **Improving service quality**
   Establishing a rating and review system that helps improve performance and encourages healthy competition among service providers.
5. **Building a reliable and sustainable system**
   Creating a platform based on trust, security, and ease of use to ensure continued growth and sustainable economic returns.

The problem that the application solves

- **From the User's Perspective (The Client):**
  - **No Reliable Reference:**
    - When a sudden breakdown happens at home (e.g., a clogged drain or electrical failure), the user starts a stressful search, asking neighbors, friends, and family: "Do you have a good plumber's number?" or "Who's tried a reliable carpenter?"
    - **The Result**: Hours wasted collecting random phone numbers and unreliable recommendations with no guarantee of quality.
  - **Lack of Price Transparency:**
    - When contacting a craftsman, the response is often vague: "It depends on the inspection" or "Let me see the work first, and we'll agree." This puts the user in a weak position and makes it impossible to compare prices between different providers.
    - **The Result**: Either overpaying for a simple service or enduring exhausting negotiations without a benchmark.
  - **Zero Transparency (Who Is This Person?):**
    - There's no way to verify the craftsman work quality or professionalism before they enter your home. Are they a beginner? Are they punctual? Do they deliver quality work?
    - **The Result**: The user takes a huge risk letting a stranger into their home with no prior reviews, ratings, or proof of past work.
  - **The Geographic Issue:**
    - A user might wait hours for a craftsmen coming from a distant area, unaware that an equally skilled (or better) professional might live on the same street or in the same neighborhood.
    - **The Result**: Wasted time, effort, and extra transportation costs for both parties.
- **From the Artisans Perspective (The Service Provider):**
  - **Over-Reliance on Word of Mouth:**
    - A skilled craftsman depends almost entirely on customer recommendations. This method is slow, inconsistent, and extremely limited in reach. If no one mentions them, they get no work.
    - **The Result**: Long idle periods between jobs and unstable monthly income.
  - **No Digital Portfolio:**
    - A lawyer or engineer can display their certificates and past projects. But a craftsman has no platform to show potential clients the quality and craftsmanship of their work unless they visit in person.

        - **The Result**: Loss of client trust before the job even starts, and difficulty justifying fair prices.
    - **Unfair Competition:**
        - Competition is based solely on price, not quality. A professional craftsman asking for a fair price for high-quality work often loses to a beginner offering a much lower price because the client has no way to tell the difference in quality beforehand.
        - **The Result**: Skilled professionals lose opportunities, while low-quality services spread in the market.
    - **Limited Access to Customers:**
        - A good craftsmen is confined to his immediate neighborhood, unaware of potential job opportunities in nearby areas.
        - **The Result**: Their skills and potential are trapped in a tiny geographic bubble.

Target audience:

- **Users (The Client):**
  Homeowners and city residents who need reliable and fast access to skilled workers, and want to compare prices, reviews, and services before making a decision.

- **Service Providers (craftsmen):**
  Independent skilled workers and small workshop owners who aim to expand their customer base, professionally showcase their services, and build a trusted reputation through ratings and reviews.

How does the app work?

1. Search for the service or handyman you need:
    - Type the service name (like "plumber" or "electrician") or the handyman's name if you know them.
    - Or browse craftsmen by category (Plumbing, Carpentry, Painting, AC, etc.).
2. View the handyman's complete profile:
    - Photos of their previous work to see their quality.
    - A list of services they offer with clear prices.
    - Real ratings and reviews from people who hired them before.

3. Search by location to find the nearest ones:
    - The app connects you with craftsmen closest to your location on the map.
4. Contact the handyman and agree on details:
    - In-app chat, send photos of the problem, and agree on the price and arrival time.
5. Get the service done and rate your experience:
    - After the job is completed, rate them and write a review to help others.

Development plan and next phases

1. Phase 1: Pilot Launch

Goal: Launch a simple, functional version with essential features to test the market and gather initial feedback.

Features:

- **Service Search:**
    - Search for craftsmen by service name (e.g., "plumber," "electrician").
    - Or browse by category (Plumbing, Electrical, Carpentry, Painting, etc.)
- **Handyman Profiles:**
    - Services offered.
    - Clear pricing (fixed or estimated).
    - Photos of previous work.
    - Ratings and reviews from customers.
- **Essential Service Details:**
    - craftsmen location (city/neighborhood).
    - Contact information (phone number or in-app chat).
    - Availability (if available now or by appointment).
- **Rating & Feedback:**
    - Users can rate handymen (1 to 5 stars).
    - Leave written reviews to help future users.
- **Limited Scope:**
    - Start with one city .
    - Focus on most requested services only (plumbing, electrical, carpentry).

2. Phase 2: Expansion and Content Enrichment

Goal: Expand coverage and add features that make finding the right handyman easier.

Features:

- **Expand to cover all services:**

        - AC repair, appliance repair, painting, tiling, blacksmithing, aluminum works, cleaning services, pest control, moving services, gardening, etc.
    - **Complete Service Details:**
        - Add estimated job duration.
        - Add response time (how fast the handyman replies).
        - Multiple contact options (call, chat, booking request).
    - **Verify More craftsmen:**
        - Onboard and verify a larger number of handymen across more neighborhoods.

3. ### Phase 3: Interaction and Personalization

Goal**:** Make Craftsmen smarter, more personalized, and keep users coming back.

Features:

- **Updates & Notifications:**
    - Users can "follow" a favorite craftsman and get notified when they're available.
    - Notify users when a craftsman they viewed gets a new review or rating.
    - Promotional notifications (e.g., "craftsmen near you are available now!").
- **User Accounts & Saved Data**
    - Save favorite craftsmen for quick access next time.
    - View past bookings and ratings history.
    - Saved addresses for quick booking.
- **Advanced Filters**
    - Filter by verified craftsman only.
    - Filter by "available now."
    - Sort by rating, distance, or price.

How do we generate revenue?

- Phase 1 – Free Launch:
    - The goal in the first phase is to build a strong user base and encourage as many craftsmen as possible to join, so that people know this is the place they go when they need a craftsperson.
- Phase 2 – Monetization:
    - Service Providers:
        - Registration remains free.

        - A commission is applied to each completed service transaction.
        - Premium features (e.g., featured listings, advanced analytics) will be offered for a subscription fee.
    - Users:
        - Basic features remain free.
        - Some advanced features (e.g., priority booking) will require a subscription.